DReSA User Manual

Version 2.1, October 2026. Digital Research Skills Australasia, https://dresa.org.au
This manual replaces version 1.4.0 (March 2022), which described the previous interface.
Version 2.1 (22 October 2026) updates section 13 for the DReSA Contributor Guide.

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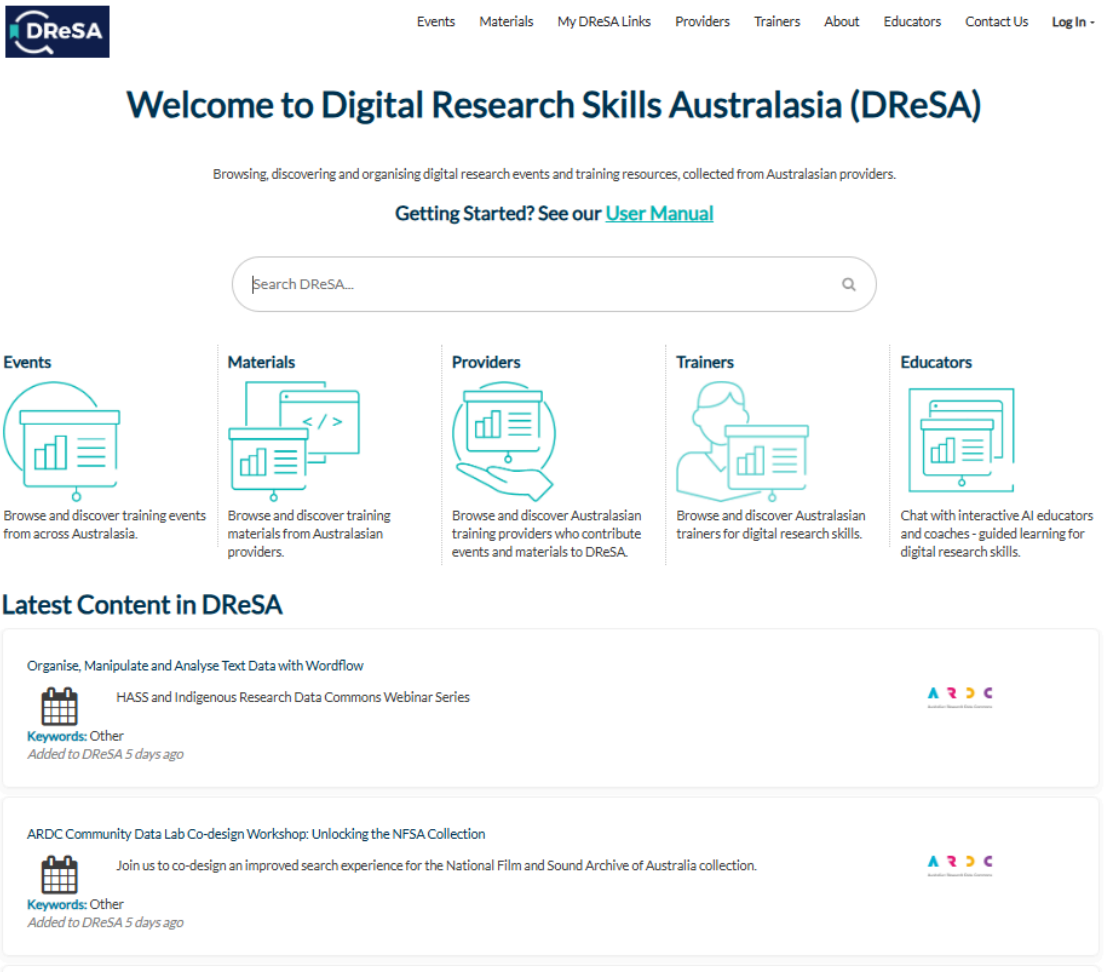
1. About DReSA and this manual

DReSA (Digital Research Skills Australasia) is a free, open registry of training in digital research skills for researchers in Australia and New Zealand. It brings together training events, training materials, the organisations that provide them, and the trainers who deliver them, so that you can search them all in one place.

DReSA is a registry, not a repository. It holds descriptions of training and links to it; the training itself stays on the provider's own site. When you find something useful, DReSA links you to the provider to register or to open the material.

DReSA began as a grassroots movement among trainers and training providers. It grew out of the ARDC's Australian eResearch and Data Skills Summit in 2020 and is built on TeSS, the open-source training registry developed by ELIXIR in Europe. The About pages on the site tell the full story.

This manual is for everyone who uses DReSA: people looking for training, trainers and providers who add it, and anyone curious about the AI educators. You do not need an account to search; you need one to add content, subscribe to updates or keep favourites.



2. What you can find in DReSA

- **Events**: training with a start and end time, such as workshops, courses, webinars, conferences, meetings, hackathons and drop-in sessions. Most are online.
- **Materials**: training you can use at any time, such as tutorials, videos, slides, lessons and full courses.
- **Providers**: the organisations and groups that contribute events and materials.
- **Trainers**: people who deliver training and have chosen to list themselves.
- **My DReSA Links**: collections, where signed-in users gather events and materials around a theme and can share them.
- **Educators**: AI educators and coaches you can talk with, grounded in curated and openly licensed sources.

How training is described

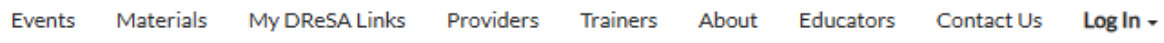
Every event and material carries labels that help you judge whether it suits you. The main ones are:

Label	Choices

Event type	Webinar; Workshop; Conference; Meeting; Hackathon; Drop-in session or hackyhour
Who can attend (eligibility)	Open to all; Host institutions; Expression of interest; By invitation
Cost	Free to all; Cost to non-members; Cost incurred by all
Competency level (materials)	Not specified; Awareness; Beginner; Intermediate; Advanced
Target audience	Undergraduate; Masters student; MBR student; PhD student; Post-doc or Fellow; Academic; Professional (research-related); Professional (other)
Material type	24 types, including Tutorial, Video Lecture, Presentation, Lesson, Module, Full Course, Quiz, Handout, Reading, Case Study, Interactive, Simulation, Diagram or Infographic, and Other
Material status	Active; In development; Archived
Licence (materials)	The licence the provider has given the material, for example Creative Commons Attribution 4.0

3. Getting around the site

The **navigation bar** at the top of every page links to Events, Materials, My DReSA Links, Providers, Trainers, About, Educators and Contact Us. On the right is Log In, or your name once you are signed in. On a phone the bar folds into a menu button.
The **home page** has a search box, a card for each section, and a "Recently added" list of the newest events and materials.
The **footer** on every page links to the Terms of Use, this manual, the Privacy page, your cookie preferences, Contact us, and the source code. It also names the organisations that fund and support DReSA, and carries our acknowledgement of country.
DReSA works on desktops, tablets and phones.



4. Searching and filtering

The search box

Type one or more words into the search box on the home page (or the one in the navigation bar on other pages) and press Enter. The results page groups matches by section: events, materials, providers, trainers and collections. Words are matched against the main fields of each

record, such as its title, description and keywords.

List pages and filters

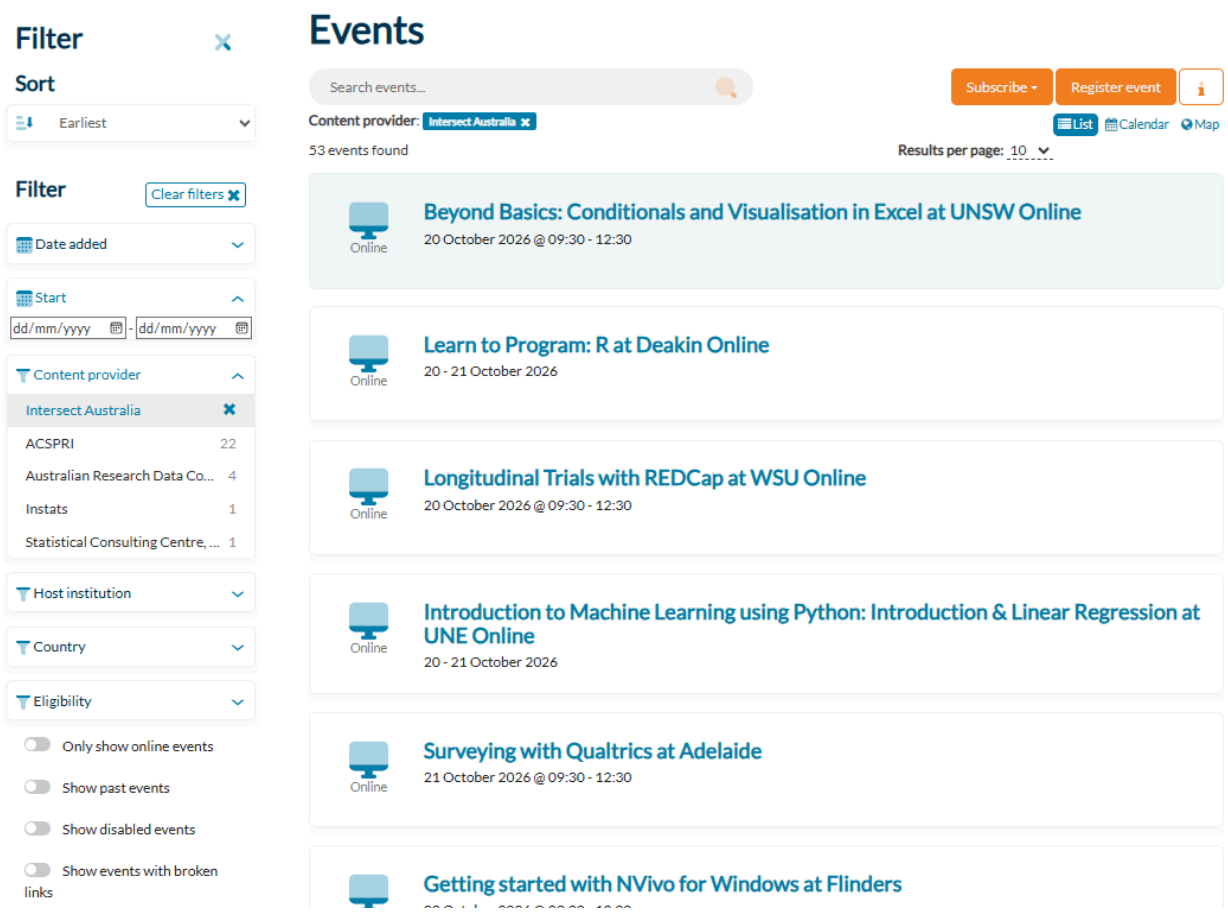
Each section has its own list page. Open Events, for example, and you see every upcoming event, newest first. Narrow the list with the filters on the left (on a phone, use the Filters button):

- **Events**: Date added, Start date, Content provider, Host institution, Keyword, Event type, Online or in person, City, Country, Venue, Organiser, Target audience, Eligibility, Language, Collection, and the person who added it.
- **Materials**: Date added, Content provider, Keyword, Competency level, Licence, Target audience, Author, Contributor, Material type, Status, Collection, and the person who added it.
- **Providers**: Keyword and Provider type.
- **Trainers**: Location, Experience, Academic expertise, Technical expertise, Fields, Interests, Activities and Languages.
- **My DReSA Links**: Keyword and owner.

Each list page also has a search box of its own that searches only that section. You can change the sort order (most recent, last modified, title) and how many results show per page (10 to 100).

The Events page can also show results as a **calendar** or on a **map** (for events with a location), using the buttons above the list.

Click any result to open its page, which shows the full description and a button to the provider's own site.



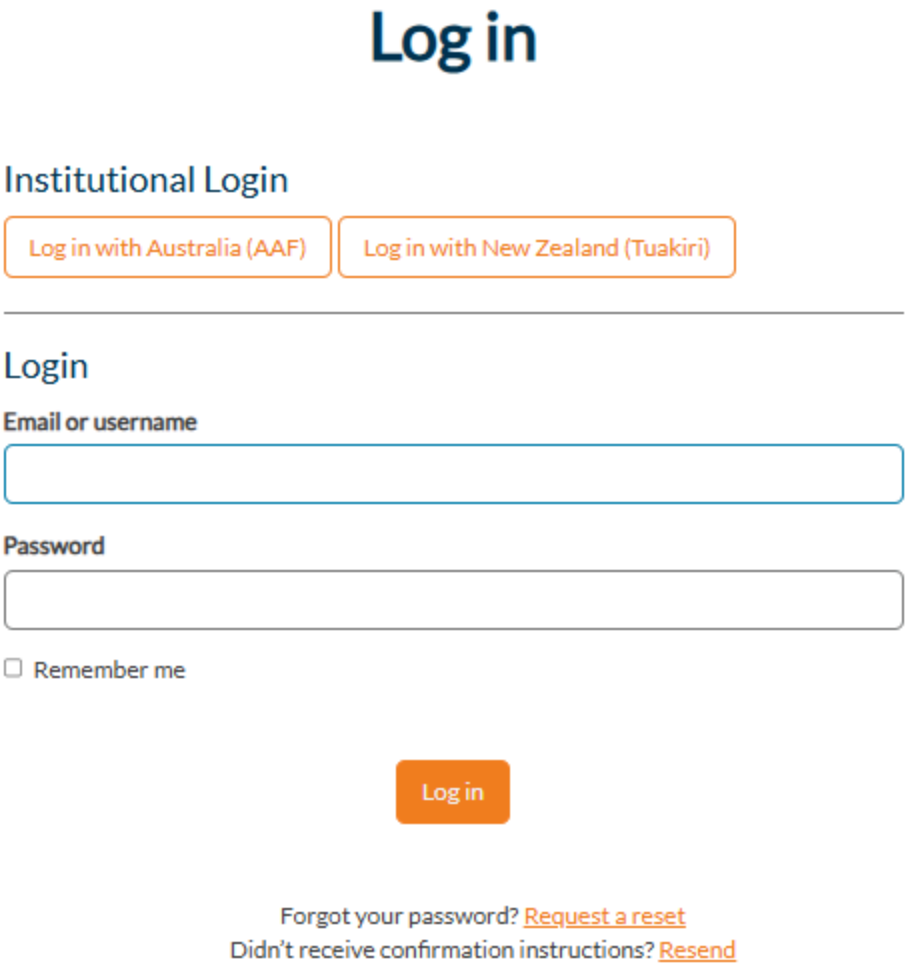
5. Signing in and your profile

Why sign in

Searching needs no account. Sign in to add events, materials or providers, to subscribe to updates, to keep favourites, to build collections, or to list yourself as a trainer.

How to sign in

Click **Log In** and choose your access federation: **Australia (AAF)** for Australian institutions or **New Zealand (Tuakiri)**. You then sign in with your own institution's username and password, as you would for other services. The first time you do this, DReSA creates your profile automatically; there is no separate registration.
The email and password boxes on the Log In page are only for accounts that the DReSA team has created by invitation. Most people never use them.
Because your login belongs to your institution, DReSA cannot change your password. If you cannot sign in, contact your institution's IT service first, then the DReSA team if the problem is on our side.



Your name menu

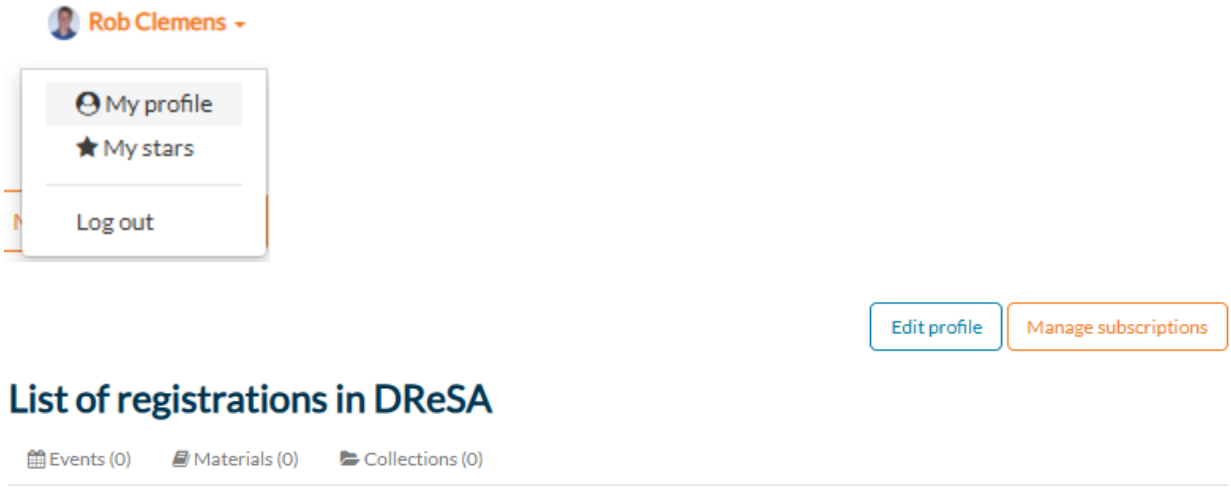
Once signed in, your name appears at the top right. Click it for your profile page, your favourites (the star), and Log out. Site administrators also see the administration links here.

Your profile

Your profile page shows your details and lists the content you have added. From it you can open **Manage account** to edit your profile and **Manage subscriptions** (section 6).
Profile fields are first name, surname, website, ORCID, public email, a short description, location, experience, language, academic and technical expertise, interests, activities and social media. All are optional unless you want to appear in the Trainers directory, which needs at least your first name, surname and description. Website and ORCID addresses are checked when you save.

Listing yourself as a trainer

Tick the box that makes your profile public, fill in your description and expertise, and save. Your entry then appears under Trainers, where people can find you by expertise, location and interests. Untick the box at any time to be removed.



User Details

⚠ Please, note that the following user details are publicly visible and so by updating these fields you are giving permission for us to share the information via your public user profile.

First name

Last name

Website

ORCID

Image

Choose File No file chosen

or enter a URL:

http://example.com/image.png

Contact email address

The image displayed with your profile is the Gravatar image associated with the provided contact email address. Gravatar provides a way to link an avatar to an email address so that it can be used across sites and platforms. To set-up a linked avatar, go to the Gravatar site: https://en.gravatar.com

Trainer Details

☐ Show in Registry of Trainers?

Summary

Location

6. Subscriptions and favourites

Email updates

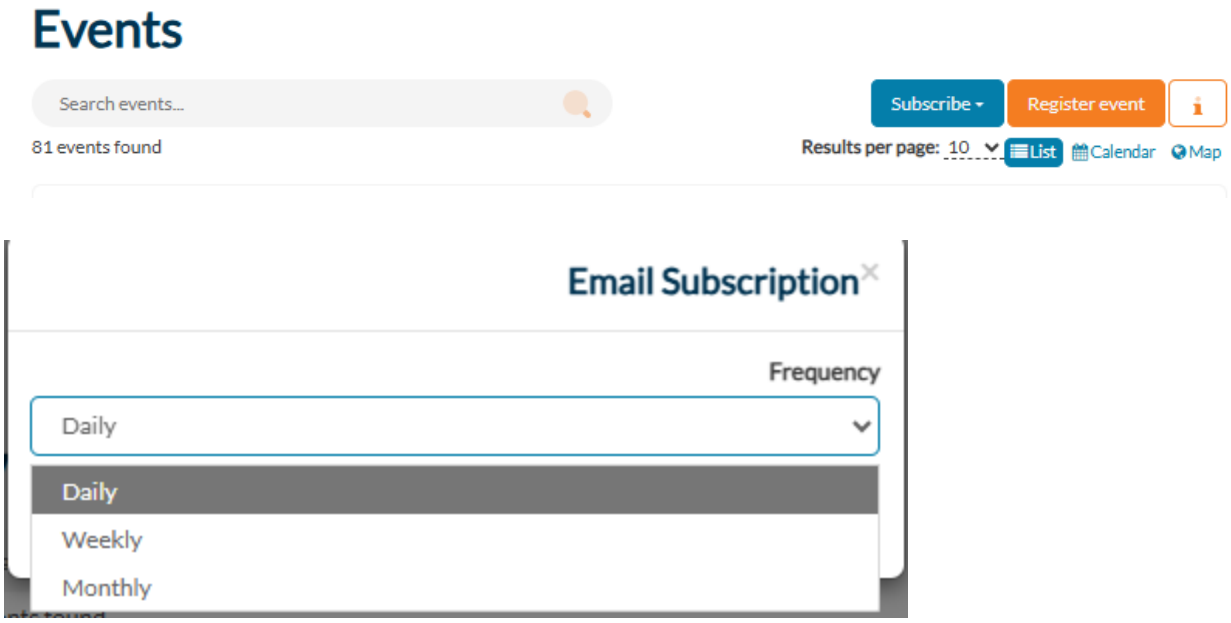
On the Events or Materials page, set the filters that interest you (for example a keyword and a provider), then click **Subscribe**. DReSA re-runs that search for you and emails you anything new every 24 hours, every week or every month, whichever you choose. You must be signed in. Open **Manage subscriptions** from your profile to see your subscriptions, view the current results of each, or cancel one.

Calendar feeds

The Subscribe button on the Events page also offers **Add to calendar**, which explains how to subscribe to DReSA events in Google Calendar or any calendar that accepts iCalendar feeds. Each event page also has an Add to calendar button for that one event.

Favourites (stars)

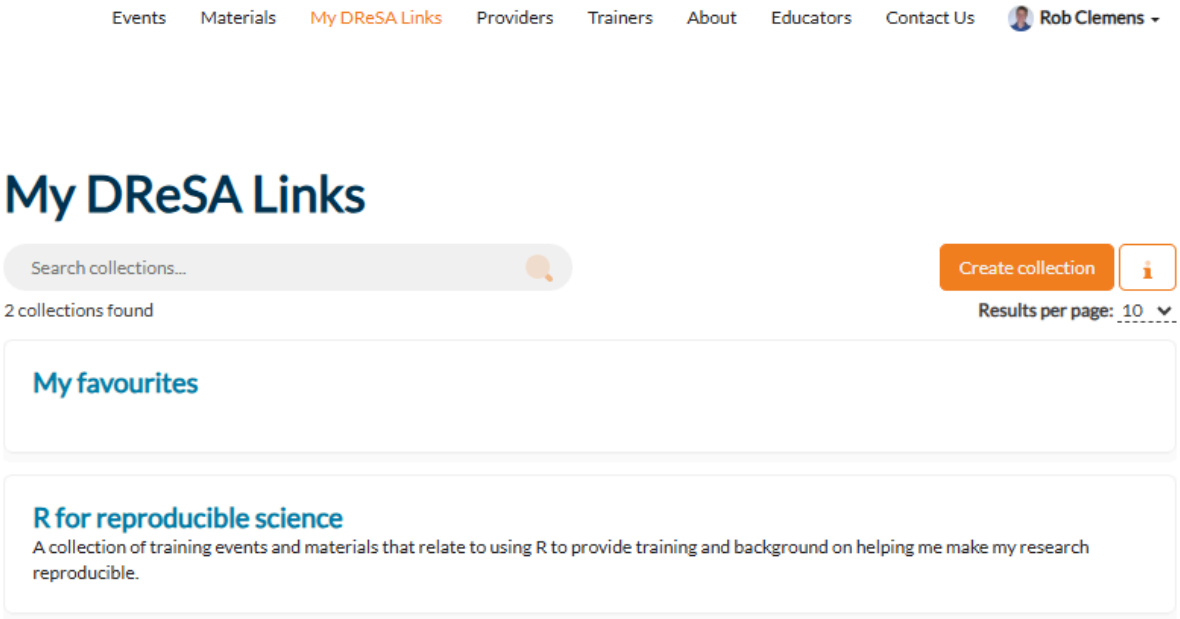
Every event and material page has a **Star** button. Starred items are collected under the star icon in your name menu. Favourites are private to you.



7. My DReSA Links (collections)

A collection is a folder of events and materials gathered around a theme, for example "R for reproducible science". Collections are useful for reading lists, course preparation and sharing a curated set with colleagues.
To create one, sign in, open **My DReSA Links** and click **Create collection**. Give it a title, a description and keywords, and decide whether it is public. Then add items: open an event or material and use its add-to-collection option, or open your collection and use its curate options

to search and add many at once. You can also set a collection's order and remove items. Private collections are visible only to you. Public collections appear in the My DReSA Links list for everyone.



8. Adding and maintaining events

Sign in, open Events and click **Register event**. If you will add many events, create a Provider first (section 10) and link each event to it, so that they appear together and can be managed as a group.

Required fields

Title, URL (the page where people register or read more), Organiser, Description, Host institutions, Contact, Eligibility, Timezone, and Start and End dates and times. Choose whether the event is **online** or in person; in-person events also need a City and Country.

Optional fields

Subtitle, Duration, Venue and Postcode, Event type, Target audience, Keywords, Scientific topics, Learning objectives, Prerequisites, Technical requirements, Capacity, Recognition of attendance, Cost basis, currency and amount, External resources, Content provider, and any related Materials.
Hover over a field for a short explanation of what to enter. For an all-day event, set the start time to 00:00 and the end time to 23:59.

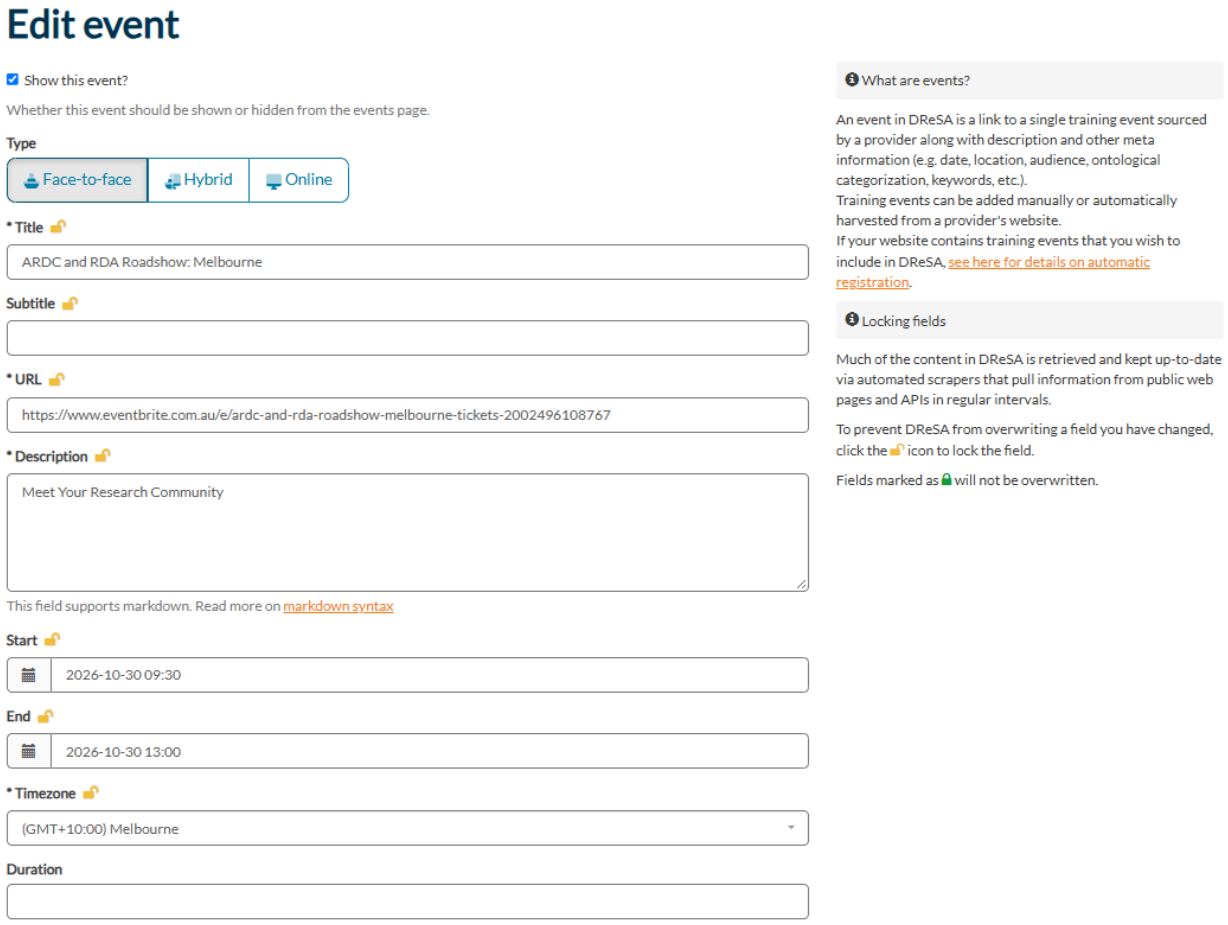
After you save

Your event appears in the Events list. Its page offers Star, Add to calendar and a button to the event's own site. As the owner you also see **Edit**, **Clone** (copies everything except the URL,

handy for a repeated course) and **Delete**.

Locked fields

Events that arrive automatically from a provider's feed are refreshed each week. If you edit such an event by hand, lock the fields you changed (click the padlock next to the field) so the next refresh does not overwrite them.



9. Adding and maintaining materials

Sign in, open Materials and click **Register training material**.

Required fields

Title, URL (where the material lives), Description, Keywords, Licence, Status (active, in development or archived) and Contact.

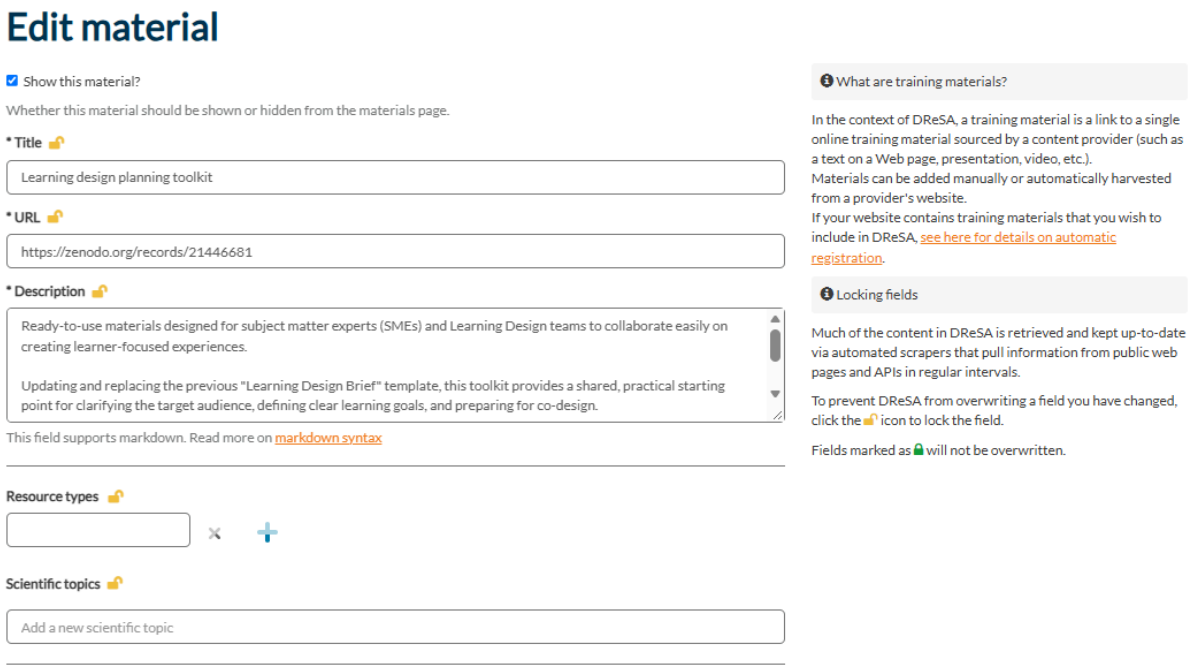
Recommended fields

DOI, Version, Content provider, Authors, Contributors, related Events, Target audience,

Prerequisites, Competency level, Learning objectives and Date created.

Optional fields

Date modified, Date published, Material type (one or more of the 24 types; if you choose Other, say what in the box that appears), Scientific topics and External resources.
After saving, the material's page offers Star and a button to the material itself; owners can Edit and Delete. Locked fields work as for events.



10. Providers

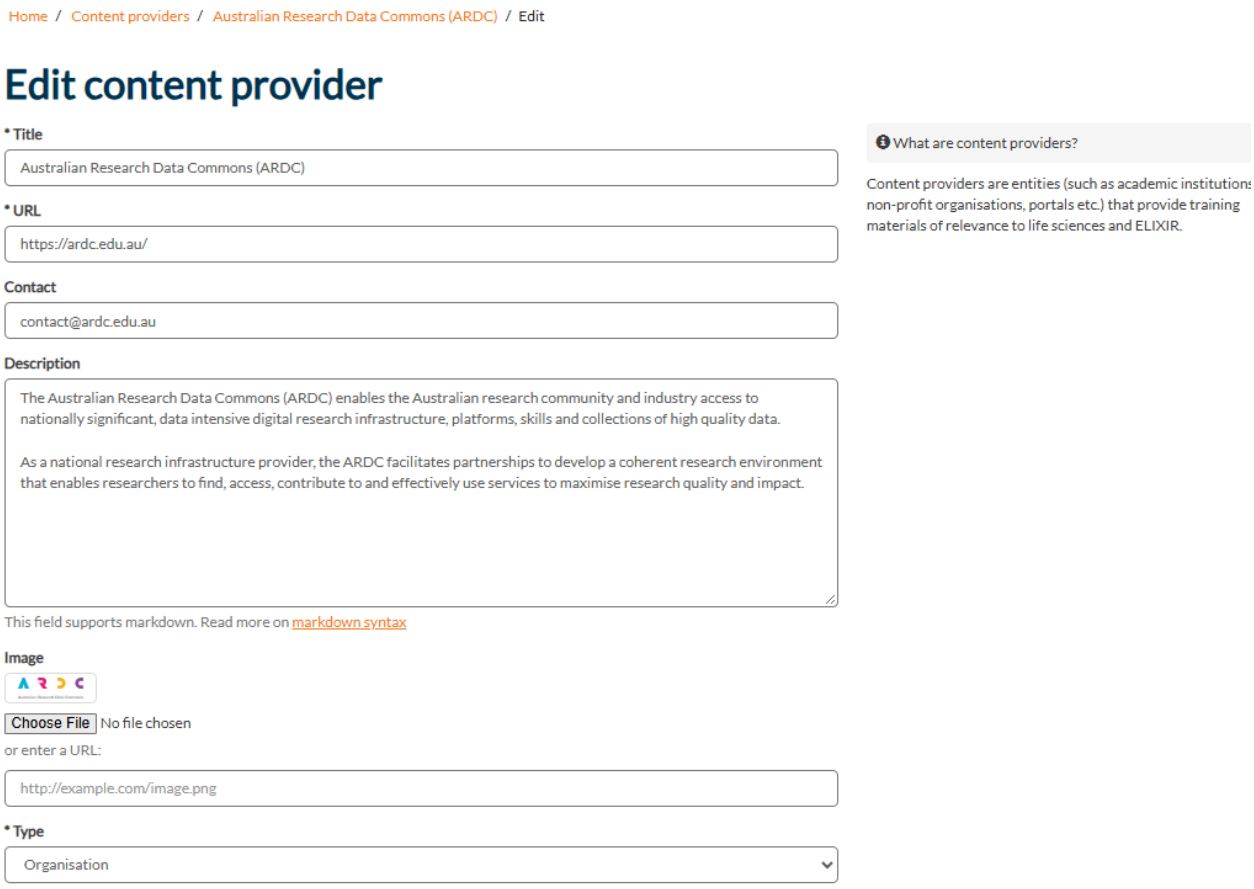
A provider is an organisation, group or project that contributes training: a university unit, a research infrastructure, a company, a community. Providers have their own list page with keyword and type filters, and each provider page lists its events and materials.

Registering a provider

Sign in, open Providers and click **Register content provider**. Required: Title, URL and Type. Optional: Description, Logo image, Keywords, and the owner (by default, you).

Managing a provider

The owner and site administrators can edit or delete a provider. Deleting a provider also deletes every event and material linked to it, so archive materials and let events expire instead where you can. If several people in your organisation add content, ask the DReSA team about the best arrangement.



11. Trainers

The Trainers page is a directory of people who deliver digital research skills training and have chosen to be listed. Filter by location, experience, expertise, interests, activities or language, and open a trainer's entry for their description, website and ORCID. To be listed yourself, see section 5.

12. The AI educators and coaches

The Educators page offers interactive AI learning assistants, grounded in curated and openly licensed sources. They are listed as tiles; click a tile to open the educator in a new tab.

- The **Educator** answers your questions directly. Use it when you have a specific question.
- The **Coaches** run guided modules with short lessons and a knowledge check at the end. Expect a coach to ask before it tells: it works through the lesson with you rather than lecturing. You can start any lesson from the "Choose a lesson" option, and repeat lessons as often as you like.

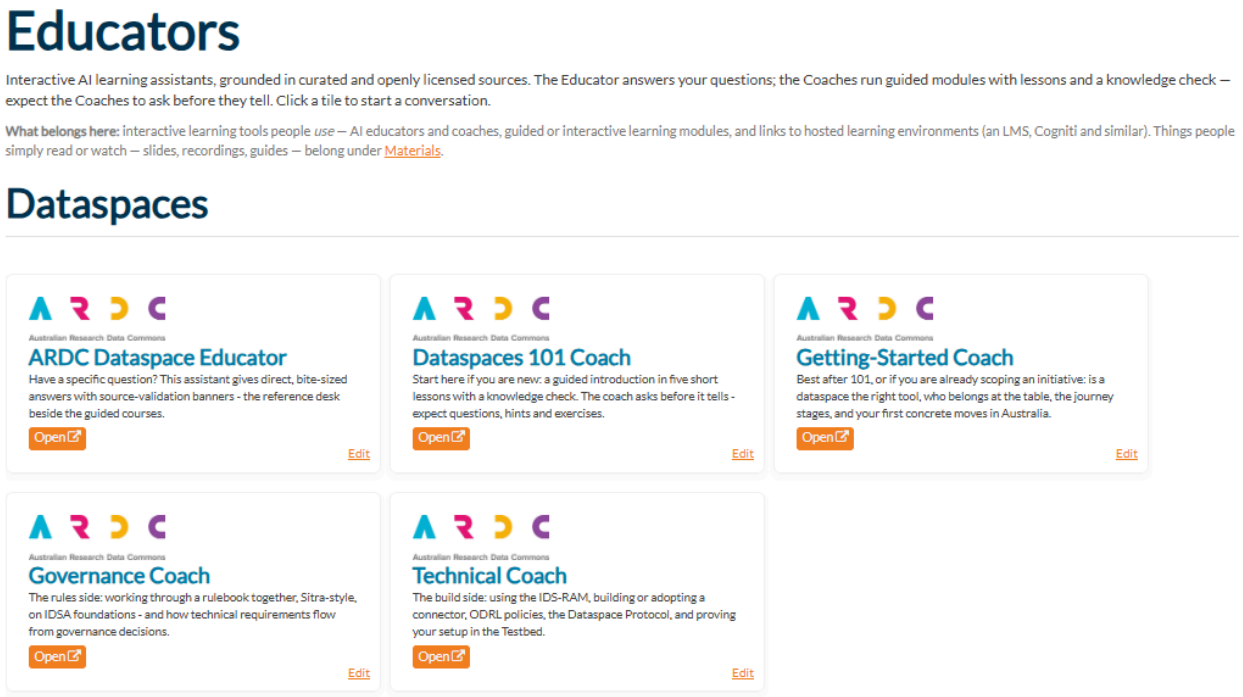
At the time of writing there are five, all on data spaces: the ARDC Dataspace Educator and the Dataspaces 101, Getting-Started, Governance and Technical coaches. More are planned.

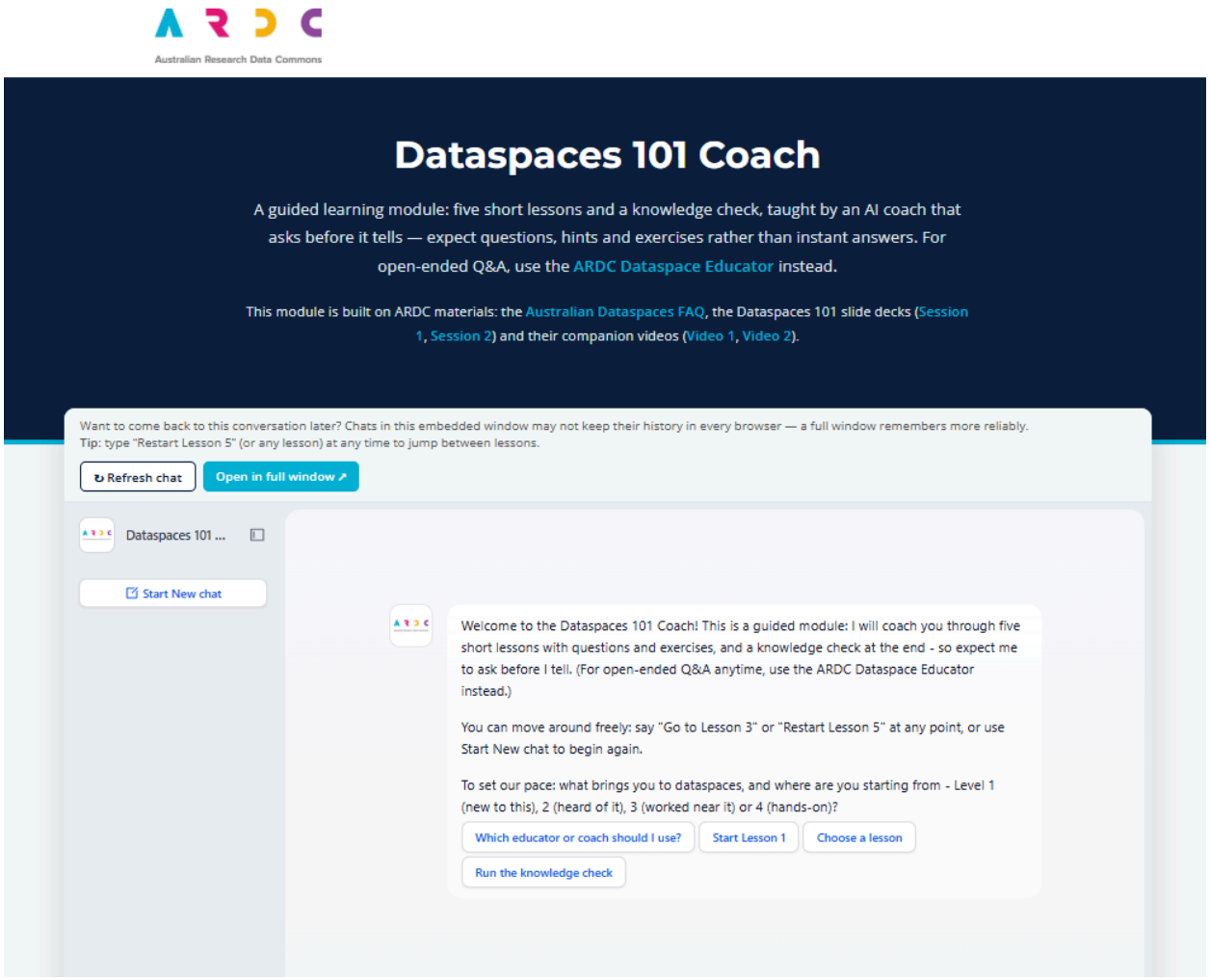
Using an educator page

Each educator page introduces the module, lists the sources it draws on, and holds the chat window. **Open in full window** gives you a larger chat that also remembers your conversation more reliably. If you leave a page for a while, use **Refresh chat** to make sure you are seeing the latest replies. The **Back to DReSA Educators** button returns you to the tiles.

Things to know

- Conversations are not linked to your DReSA account, and you do not need to sign in.
- Do not enter personal, confidential or unpublished information; treat the chat as public.
- The educators answer from their sources and say so when a question is outside them. They can still make mistakes: check anything important against the linked sources.
- Feedback is welcome through the Contact us link.





13. Adding content automatically: feeds, CSV files and the API

Providers with many events or materials can have DReSA pull them in automatically each week instead of typing them in. Current options:

- **CSV file**: keep a spreadsheet of your events or materials at a web address (for example on GitHub) in the DReSA column layout. Templates: https://dresa.org.au/event_csv_template.csv and https://dresa.org.au/material_csv_template.csv. Save as CSV in UTF-8 encoding.
- **iCalendar feed**: an .ics feed of your events.
- **Existing platforms**: Eventbrite, Zenodo and other TeSS registries.
- **Your own system**: DReSA has a JSON API for reading data and for contributors who want to push records; see the Developers page under About.

Column layouts, allowed values and matching rules are in the **DReSA Contributor Guide** (https://dresa.org.au/DReSA-Contributor-Guide.pdf), which lists every field, allowed term and feed type. The older DReSA Ingestion Guide (https://dresa.org.au/DReSA-Ingestion-Guide.pdf) is kept for reference. To set up a feed, contact the DReSA team with the address of your file or

feed and the name of your provider record; records that arrive this way are matched on title and URL, so updates refresh existing entries rather than creating duplicates.
DReSA content can also be shown on your own website using widgets, and read through the API; the Developers page explains both.

14. Getting help

Use the **Contact Us** link in the navigation bar or footer for questions, feedback, or help with adding content. The About pages explain what DReSA is, how to register content, the developers' options, and who is behind DReSA. The FAQ page under About answers common questions about accounts, privacy and adding training.